

Welcome to Mastery English

Welcome, and thank you for joining us. You already command English: you work, study, argue, and joke in it. This course is about what lies beyond command: **precision, nuance, and effect**. Over thirteen weeks you will learn to choose the one exactly right word, to move between registers as deliberately as you change gear, to hear what speakers mean but never say, to write prose that a reader chooses to keep reading, to negotiate and disagree with grace, and to hold a room. The question is rarely "Is this correct?" any more. It is "Is this exactly right, for this reader, in this moment?"

Some of you have just completed our C1 course; others join us with years of professional life in English behind you, as translators, teachers, researchers, managers, or writers. Many of you move between two or more languages every day. That range of experience is this class's greatest resource, and every one of you is welcome here.

WHEN AND WHERE

Days:

Time:

Place / Room:

First class:

Last class:

The course runs for **13 weeks**, with **two 90-minute classes** a week: **26 classes** in all. Four of them have a special shape:

CLASS 12

A halfway masterwork: a short talk you prepare, deliver, and discuss.

CLASS 13

A progress check on the first half, so you know exactly what to polish next.

CLASS 25

Your final masterwork, delivered and defended in a searching discussion.

CLASS 26

A final check, including a one-to-one conversation with your teacher, then a celebration and certificates.

WHAT TO BRING

- ◆ Your **workbook**, to every class. Your teacher will give it to you.
- ◆ A notebook and pen, and your phone if you have one (for the online lessons and for recording yourself).
- ◆ A **commonplace book**: a notebook, or a note on your phone, where you copy, verbatim, the phrases, collocations, and sentences you admire. At this level, a well-kept collection of other people's best sentences teaches more than any word list.
- ◆ Something you are reading in English, whatever it is. We will often start from what you have noticed.

HOW OUR CLASS WORKS

Arrive on time.

Every class opens with a short speaking task that recycles the last one.

Phones on silent.

We use them only for class activities and recordings.

Feedback is about choices.

At C2 you will rarely hear "that's wrong." You will hear about precision (is there a more exact word?), appropriacy (does it suit this reader and this room?), naturalness (would a skilled writer or speaker put it this way?), and effect (does it land?).

Take risks.

Try the bolder word, the riskier register, the joke. Your teacher notes what to refine and comes back to it later, never mid-sentence.

Let your teacher know

if you can't come, and do the online lesson at home.

Your story is yours.

When a task touches your life, a real, general, or imagined example is always equally welcome.

HOW OUR WORKSHOPS AND CRITIQUE WORK

Many classes end in a **workshop**: a text, a talk, or a performance that classmates read or hear, and respond to. Good critique makes both the writer and the reader better. These norms keep it rigorous *and* generous:

The author listens first.

When your work is discussed, listen without defending it. You'll have the last word.

Start with what works, and say why.

"The short sentence after the long one landed hard" helps; "I liked it" does not.

Describe the effect before you suggest a fix.

"At this point I stopped trusting the narrator" tells the writer more than "change this word."

One or two precise suggestions.

Choose the changes that would matter most, and quote the exact words.

Critique the choice, never the person.

"This metaphor collides with the one before it," not "You always overwrite."

The author decides.

Thank your readers, ask a question if something is unclear, and decide later which suggestions to take.

HOW WE DISCUSS, DEBATE, AND LAUGH

Challenge the idea, not the person.

Acknowledge first, then disagree: "I take your point, but I see it differently."

Share the floor.

If you have spoken a lot, hand over by name: "Where do you stand, Amira?"

Assigned sides are normal.

You may argue a position you don't hold; nobody has to reveal a personal view.

Some topics stay outside.

We argue about work, education, science, the arts, technology, language, and community life, not party politics or religion.

Humor aims at situations, or at ourselves.

We study irony and wit closely, but never at the expense of a nationality, a religion, an accent, or a disability.

Nobody is a sample.

When we discuss cultures and varieties of English, no one is asked to perform their accent or to speak "for" a culture.

USEFUL PHRASES FOR CLASS

WHEN YOU WANT PRECISION

Is there a difference in nuance between ____ and ____?

Would ____ sound natural here, or slightly off?

Which of these would land better with this reader?

Is that a British or an American usage?

IN DISCUSSION

Could I just come in on that?

That assumes ____, which I'd question.

I take your point; where I'd differ is ____.

So where does that leave us?

IN A WORKSHOP

What works particularly well here is ____, because ____.

At this point, as a reader, I felt ____.

Mastery English (C2): free

Every class has a matching **online lesson** with the same concepts, model texts, dialogues, and exercises. It is your homework, and it lets you catch up if you miss a class. It works on a phone, a tablet, or a computer.

rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/

- 1 Open the website, or scan the QR code with your phone camera.
- 2 Choose the lesson your teacher gives you (for example, **Lesson 2.1**).
- 3 Press the  buttons to hear the model sentences and dialogues. Then **shadow** them: speak along with the audio, matching its pauses, stress, and tone, especially where the tone carries the meaning (irony, reservation, a polite refusal). (No sound? Turn up the volume, or try the Chrome browser. The Audio control lets you choose a US or UK voice and slow it down.)
- 4 Do the exercises and the quiz, then the lesson project. Record your spoken projects, listen back a day later, and note one thing to refine in your learning journal.



Scan me

Aim for **45–60 minutes, 2–3 times** a week, plus serious reading every day: a novel, long-form journalism, an essay collection, or the best writing in your own field.

The online lessons and our classes both use American English (*color, summarize, program, apartment*). British English (*colour, summarise, programme, flat*) is just as correct, and your teacher accepts it; one lesson explores the differences. At C2 the rule is simple: **choose one and hold it consistently** within a piece of writing.

Translation tools and more practice

This free page shows how to **translate** a lesson into your language, and lists free tools for listening, pronunciation, and speaking practice.

`rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum/learning-tools.html`

At C2, work in English first. Translation is most useful for a different job: comparing how two languages handle the same idea, which is exactly what we do in the lesson on working between languages. For listening, choose podcasts, lectures, comedy, and drama in English from as many varieties as you can find.



Scan me

My teacher

Name: _____

Phone / text: _____

Email: _____

Other help: _____

Can't come to class? A short message is enough: "Hi, it's _____. I'm afraid I won't be able to make it today. I'll catch up on the online lesson before our next class." (Or write it in whatever register suits your relationship with your teacher. That's practice too.)

YOU'RE READY FOR THIS

At C1 you learned to be precise. Here you will learn to be **exact, and to make it look effortless**: to hear a language in stereo, meaning in one channel and feeling in the other, and to choose with intent. The gains at this level are quiet, and they can feel like refinement rather than progress. They are exactly what makes readers keep reading and rooms keep listening. By the end, you will deliver a masterwork of your own and defend it in discussion, in English, as yourself. We're very glad you're here. Welcome.

